

MIT News: One ChatGPT query uses 5x the energy of a Google search. By 2026, AI data centers will consume more electricity than Japan.

Posted by u/EchoOfOppenheimer • 0 points • 7 comments

MIT researchers detail the staggering environmental footprint of Generative AI. Beyond the well-known energy costs of training (where one model can consume enough power for 120 homes), the article highlights that **inference**, actual daily use, is the bigger threat.

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-15 20:33 UTC

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u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-13 08:23 UTC

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u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-12 23:43 UTC

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u/sagittariisXII • 6 points • 2026-01-12 21:18 UTC

I'm curious how the AI Overview that a lot of search engines now have impacts this

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-12 21:17 UTC

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u/prototyperspective • 7 points • 2026-01-12 18:55 UTC

I think LLMs aren't very useful for finding factual information and think most of their users don't know how to use them well and should learn more about flaws in LLMs and how to search the Web. However, one question to an LLM could save people 5+ Google searches (and/or 5+ clicks through various websites).

u/FeliciaFailure • 3 points • 2026-01-13 02:35 UTC

I disagree, since if people are aware of how likely those results are to be factually inaccurate, then they will have to search more to fact-check it anyway.

On the other hand, I've been searching FAR more and clicking through way more websites since

2022 because of the amount of AI slop I find when I search for factual information, recipes, guides, etc. Even if you use things like "-ai" in your searches, you still get front page websites that are clearly AI content farms. The overall effect is more wasteful, whether you use gen AI or not.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-12 18:17 UTC

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